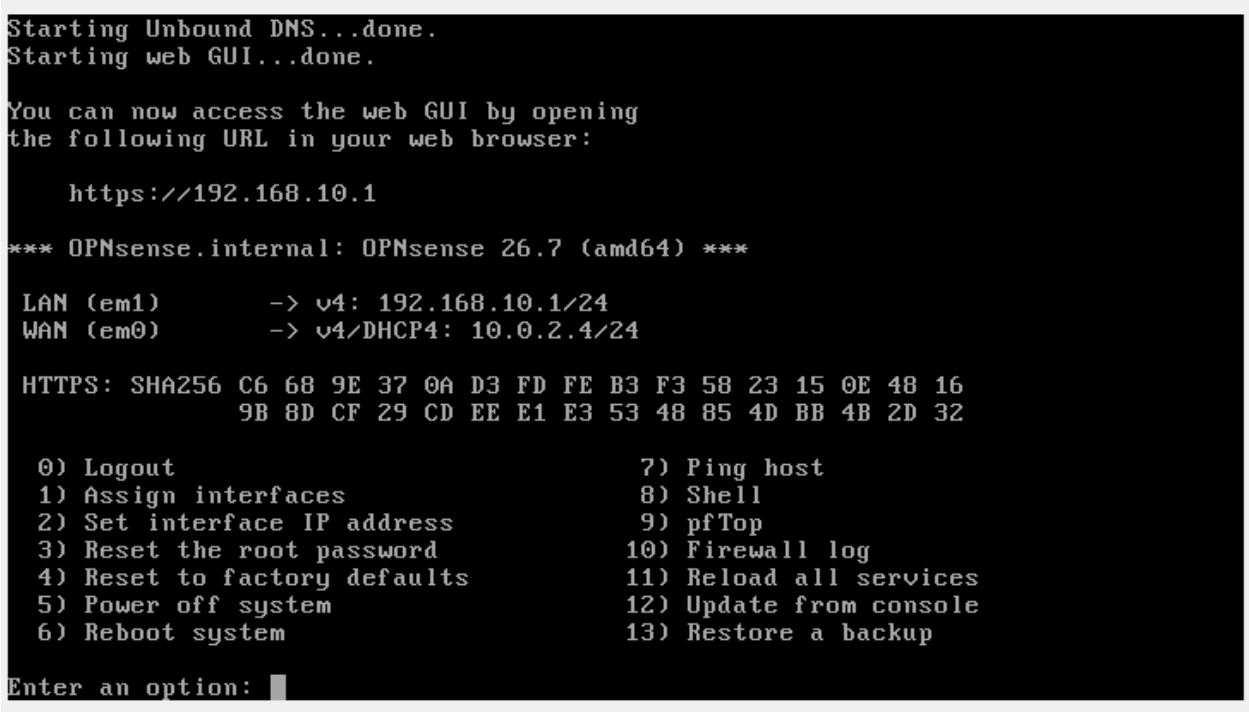
Home Lab Project Week 9, day 1

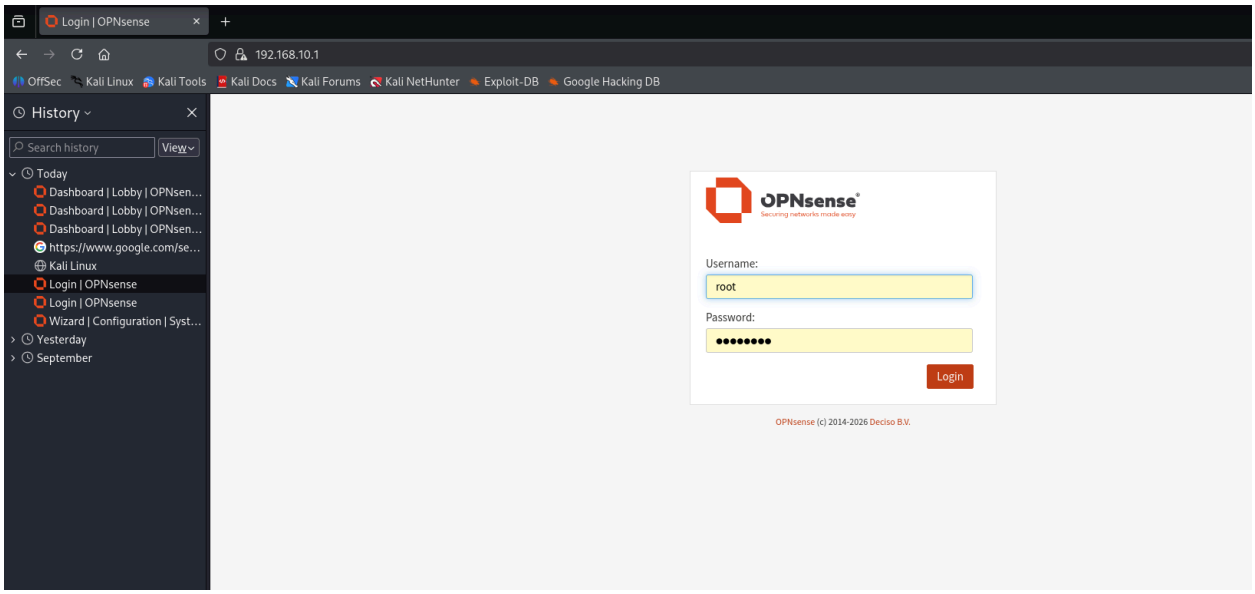
Task:
Access the OPNSense web management interface and review the existing firewall configuration. Document the default rules and current traffic behavior.

1. Access the web GUI

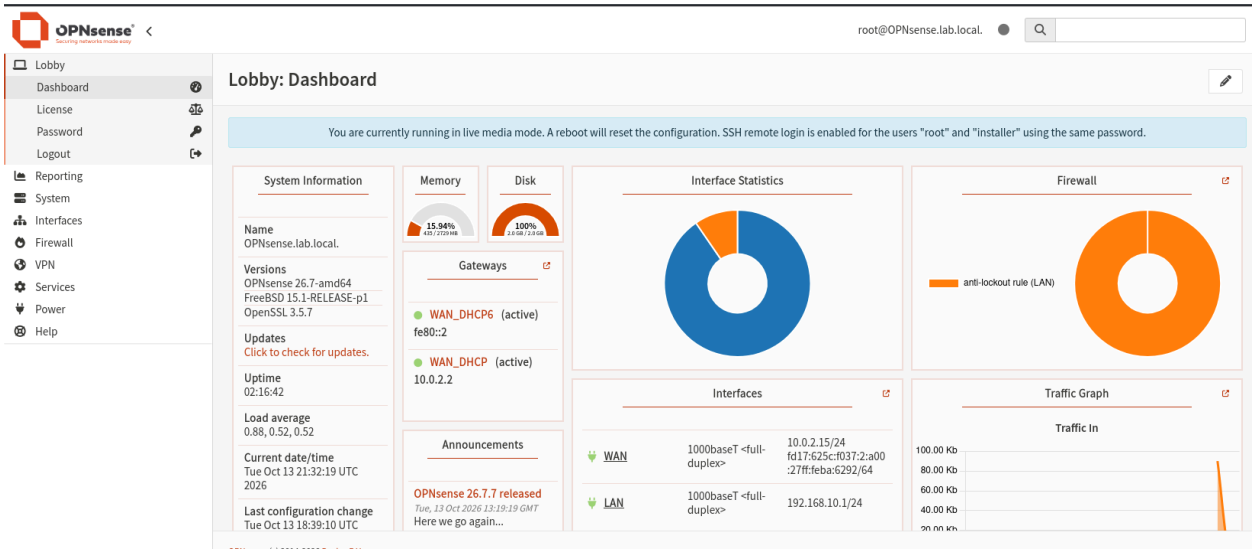


From Kali's browser:

https://192.168.1.1

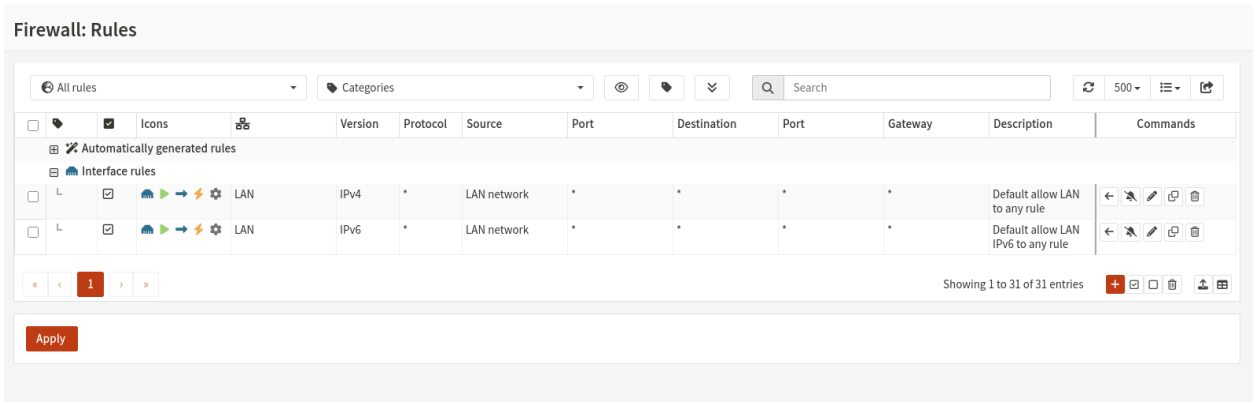


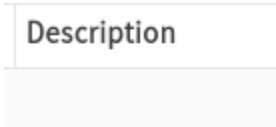
Log in with `root` / `opnsense` (or whatever you've since changed it to). You'll hit the self-signed certificate warning — click through it (Advanced → Proceed), same as before.

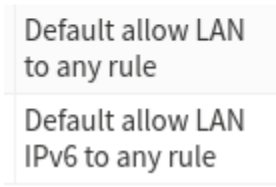


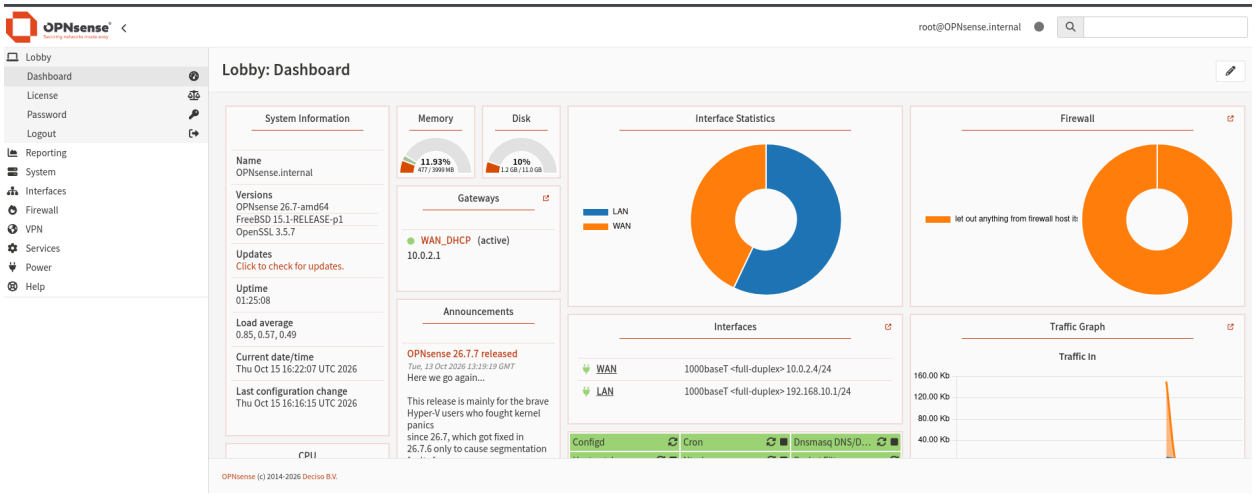
2. Navigate to the firewall rules

Go to **Firewall** → **Rules**. You'll see tabs across the top for each interface — **WAN**, **LAN**, and **Floating** (rules that can apply across multiple interfaces).

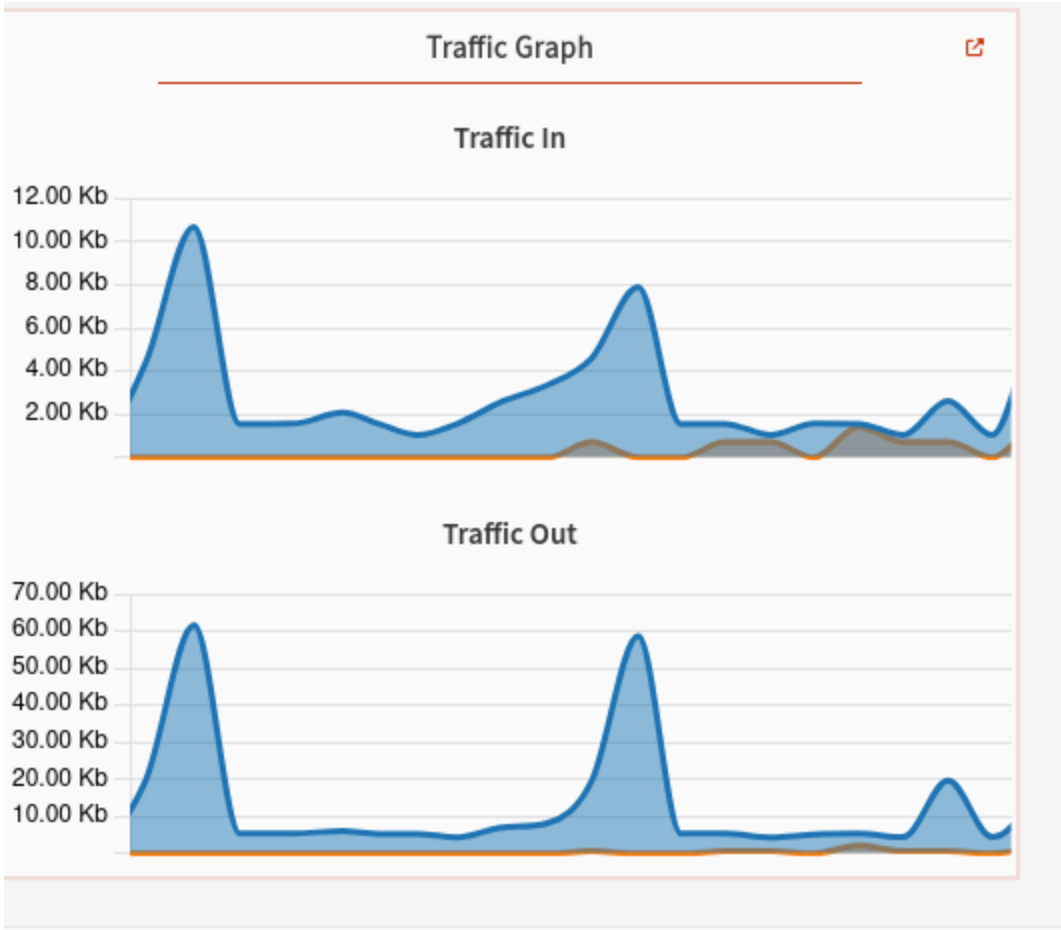


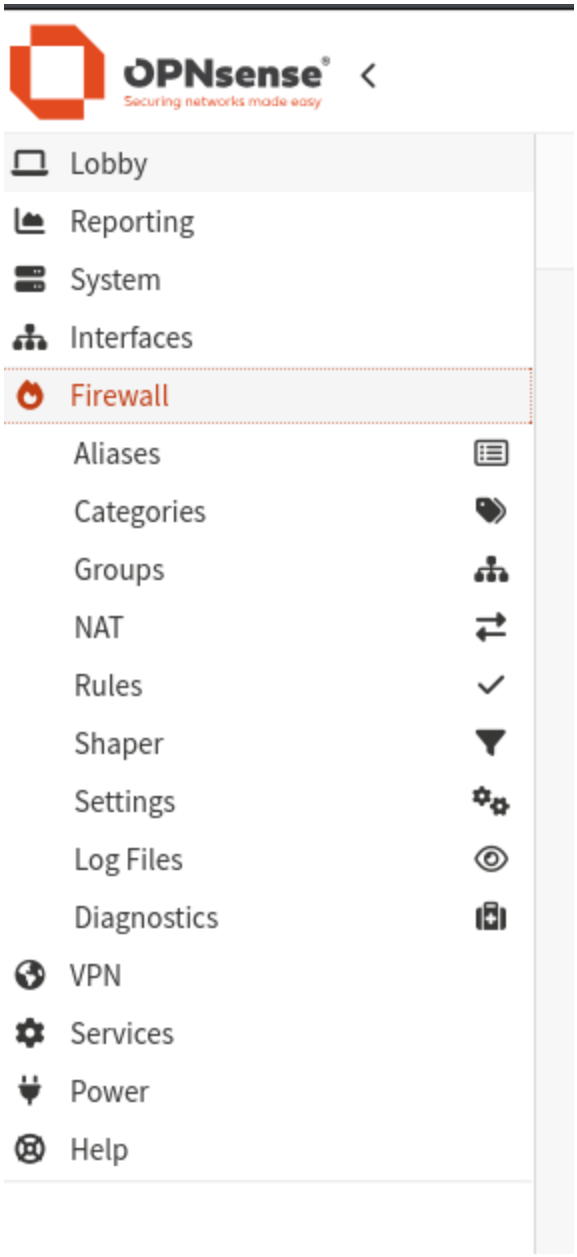






Traffic Behavior


Traffic Graph
Traffic In
12.00 Kb
10.00 Kb
8.00 Kb
6.00 Kb
4.00 Kb
2.00 Kb
Traffic Out
70.00 Kb
60.00 Kb
50.00 Kb
40.00 Kb
30.00 Kb
20.00 Kb
10.00 Kb



3. Document what's on each tab — this is the actual deliverable

WAN tab: On a fresh OPNsense install, this is typically **empty** — no rules at all. That's intentional and important to call out in your write-up: an empty WAN rule set means **default-deny** is in effect for anything coming from WAN, since OPNsense (like most stateful firewalls) blocks everything not explicitly allowed. Screenshot this empty list — "no rules" is itself a meaningful finding, not a gap in your work.

LAN tab: You'll typically see one or two default rules already present:

- An **anti-lockout rule** (sometimes auto-generated and not always shown as an editable rule, depending on version) — this is what let Kali reach `192.168.1.1` for management earlier.
- A default **"Allow LAN to any"** rule — this is why your LAN-side devices (Kali) can reach out anywhere (including WAN) by default. Screenshot this rule, noting its source/destination/action.

4. Check the logs for current traffic behavior

Go to **Firewall → Log Files → Live View**. Let it sit for a minute or two while background traffic happens. You're looking to document:

- What's being **passed** (green entries) — likely your LAN traffic
- What's being **blocked** (red entries) — likely unsolicited noise hitting the WAN interface, which is valuable evidence of default-deny actually working

Screenshot a handful of entries of each type.

5. Write up your findings

For your documentation, structure it as:

- **Default WAN ruleset:** empty → implicit deny-all inbound from WAN
- **Default LAN ruleset:** allow LAN-to-any (outbound permissive), anti-lockout rule preserving management access
- **Observed traffic:** cite a few actual log lines showing pass/block in action

This sets up Day 2 naturally — you're about to tighten the WAN side further and build targeted LAN rules, so having "here's what existed before I touched anything" documented now gives you a clean before/after comparison for your final report.

Want to pull up the Rules page and Live View now and walk through what you actually see, or is there a specific part of this you want to dig into first?